

up visits. Moreover, administration, billing and store personnel will be able to keep track of daily expenses, generate discharge summaries and manage purchases.

If the available software application doesn't meet the expectations, then custom software needs to come in based on the requirements. However, this process takes time and can be expensive depending upon the scenario.

Hospitals should provide adequate training to counter staffs, doctors and nurses to enable them to work with the installed software application. Moreover, a reliable backup and disaster management system should also be created to manage any unforeseen circumstances such as hard drive failures. The monitoring system connects to several computers, modems routers and other devices. Hence, it needs to be protected with surge equipments to protect against damages caused by thunder and lighting.

The medical record system should be developed in such a way that data is replicated across several backup servers both onsite and remote locations. This will enable data recovery in case of any system failure. Hospitals should have reliable broadband internet to ensure uninterrupted connectivity, which is essential for the successful running of the system.

A big challenge to implement a digital medical record system is security. Practice Fusion (practicefusion.com) provides a facility to track and manage medical records on the cloud. The system stores data on their own servers and we need to make sure that data is stored in encrypted format. We will not be able to know where and how data is stored. Moreover, if the provider faces problems then all the valuable data will be unavailable, which will prove costly for hospitals.

There will be challenges, obstacles and loopholes during and after the installation of patient management systems but with courage and determination it can be overcome to a great extent. All of this that we explained here, through the example of hospital record keeping, is a small part of IoT at work.

Connected medical devices

With the rapid evolution of technology, healthcare providers need to incorporate connected medical devices to provide quality healthcare to patients. These devices mainly communicate with either other devices, smartphones, tablets and patient monitoring system software applications.

QardioArm is a small wireless blood pressure monitor which displays readings on an LCD panel. These monitors are normally connected to the arm, which send signals to the app via sensors. The data is stored for future